

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Infants & children during disruption

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QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Keep children with a trusted caregiver and plan safe feeding, water, hygiene, medicines and warmth around their age and needs. Put written contacts with each child and agree a reunion plan. Use age-appropriate feeding guidance; do not dilute formula or use unsafe water to stretch supplies.

Do now.

- ☐ **Name the caregiver**
01 Decide who stays with each child during sheltering and travel. Use a familiar trusted backup; do not hand children to unverified helpers.
- ☐ **Protect feeding**
02 Maintain breastfeeding where applicable. Ready-to-feed formula can avoid preparation water needs when available; follow product and age-specific guidance. Do not improvise formula or change dilution.
- ☐ **Keep hygiene supplies**
03 Pack nappies, wipes, soap, clean clothing and safe water for essential care. Keep feeding equipment clean and separate from waste.
- ☐ **Keep a contact card**
04 Use necessary caregiver contact details and medical information without displaying sensitive identity details publicly. Teach older children the agreed safe contacts.
- ☐ **Use simple explanations**
05 Explain the next action calmly and specifically. Familiar routines and a comfort item can help; avoid promising that you know when danger will end.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Use the caregiver plan and safe supplies already available while seeking verified medical or feeding support. Do not stretch formula with extra water or leave a child alone to find supplies.

Watch for.

Infants can deteriorate quickly with dehydration, temperature exposure or illness. Seek qualified care for concerning symptoms; do not rely on adult treatment advice.

People & practical needs.

Assign a trusted adult to each person who needs assistance. Keep medicines, essential contacts and a workable reunion plan with the group

Next decision.

Plan quantities for the actual feeding and care routine, and ask a qualified clinician for special dietary or medical needs. Include medications and transport or sleeping arrangements.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

[Ready.gov · Planning for families](#)

[CDC · Infant feeding in emergencies](#)

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/preparedness/infant-child-preparedness/>